

The Lost Sheep

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories - Book 9

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For every child who knows they are precious and loved by God.

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[PICTURE: Jesus sitting with a group of people under a tree, telling a story with gentle hand gestures, people listening closely. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

One day, Jesus told a beautiful story to teach people about God's love. Everyone gathered close to listen. It was a story about a shepherd and his sheep.

[illegible]

(Pronunciation: ረገጽ = zanta = story, ገጽ = gwasā = shepherd, ለገሰ ጽጌ = abaqi'e = sheep)

[PICTURE: A kind shepherd standing on a green hillside with 100 fluffy white sheep grazing peacefully around him, holding a staff. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jesus said, "There was a good shepherd who had one hundred sheep. He loved every single one of them. He knew each sheep by name."

[illegible]

(Pronunciation: $\square\square\square$ = *mi'iti* = one hundred, $\square\square\square$ = *begi'e* = sheep, $\square\square\square$ = *bisma* = by name)

Page 3

[PICTURE: The shepherd gently petting a sheep, feeding another, counting them lovingly, green meadow with wildflowers. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Every morning, the shepherd counted his sheep. One, two, three... all the way to one hundred. He made sure they were all safe and happy.

TIGRINYA:

በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ... በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ
በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ በነፃ

(Pronunciation: በነፃ = *nigho* = morning, በነፃ = *yiqots'ir* = counting, በነፃ = *wiHusat* = safe)

[PICTURE: The shepherd leading his flock to a sparkling stream of water, sheep drinking happily, lush green grass all around. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The shepherd led his sheep to fresh green grass and cool water. He protected them from danger. He took care of them day and night.

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(Pronunciation: ʃa'iri = grass, may = water, yiHilwen = protects them)

Page 5

[PICTURE: One curious little sheep looking away from the flock toward a butterfly near some distant hills, beginning to wander. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

One day, one little sheep saw a pretty butterfly. She followed it over a hill. She wandered farther and farther away from the flock without noticing.

TIGRINYA:

፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡
፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡

(Pronunciation: ፡፡፡፡ = birabird = butterfly, ፡፡፡፡ = korebta = hill, ፡፡፡ = menga = flock)

Page 6

[PICTURE: The little sheep alone in an unfamiliar rocky place, looking confused and scared, the flock nowhere in sight. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Soon the little sheep was lost! She looked around but could not see the other sheep anywhere. She could not find her way back home. She was all alone.

TIGRINYA:

ጥጥጥ ልጅ ጥጥጥ ልጅ ጥጥጥ! ልጅ ጥጥጥ ልጥጥ ልጅ ልጥጥ ጥጥጥ ልጅ ልጥጥ ልጅ
ጥጥጥጥጥ ጥጥጥጥጥጥ ልጅ ልጅ ጥጥጥ ጥጥጥጥ ጥጥጥጥጥጥ ልጥጥ ጥጥጥጥ

(Pronunciation: ጥጥጥ = t'ef'at = lost, ልጅ ጥጥጥ = ab zuryaa = around her, ልጥጥ = beyna = alone)

Page 7

[PICTURE: The little sheep crying "Baa! Baa!" on a rocky ledge, thorns caught in her wool, looking frightened as it gets dark. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

The little sheep cried, "Baa! Baa!" She was scared and cold. Thorny bushes scratched her soft wool. It was getting dark and she was afraid.

TIGRINYA:

ገጽ ስፍራ ስፍራ "ባ! ባ!" ገጽ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ
ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ ስፍራ

(Pronunciation: ስፍራ = nebe'at = cried, ስፍራ = feriHa = scared, ስፍራ = ashokhat = thorns)

Page 8

[PICTURE: The shepherd counting his sheep at sunset - 97, 98, 99 - looking worried as he realizes one is missing. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Back home, the shepherd counted his sheep. "...ninety-seven, ninety-eight, ninety-nine..." He counted again. One sheep was missing! His heart filled with worry.

TIGRINYA:

ገሙ ገሙ ገሙ ገሙ ገሙ "ግዓት'የሩ ግዓት'የሩ ግዓት'የሩ ግዓት'የሩ ግዓት'የሩ..."
ገሙ ግዓት'የሩ ግዓት'የሩ ገሙ ገሙ ገሙ! ገሙ ግዓት'የሩ ግዓት'የሩ

(Pronunciation: ገሙ = qots'ere = counted, ግዓት'የሩ = godila = missing, ግዓት'የሩ = shaqilot = worry)

[PICTURE: The shepherd leaving the 99 sheep safely in a fenced green meadow, grabbing his staff, heading toward dark hills. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The shepherd left the ninety-nine sheep safe together. He grabbed his walking stick and went to look for his one lost sheep. He would not rest until he found her!

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file:///projects/sandbox/children-bible-stories/books/book09_lost_sheep.html

[PICTURE: The shepherd searching through dark valleys, looking behind rocks, calling out for his lost sheep, determined face. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The shepherd searched everywhere. He looked behind big rocks. He looked in deep valleys. He called out to his lost sheep. "Little one, where are you?"

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 000000 000 0000 "000000 000 000?"

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Page 11

[PICTURE: The shepherd climbing steep rocky hills in the dark, moonlight shining, scratching his arms on thorns, still searching. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

The shepherd climbed steep hills and crossed rocky ground. Thorns scratched his arms and legs. But he did not stop! He loved his lost sheep too much to give up.

TIGRINYA:

ገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም
ገላላ ሰላም! ገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም ለገላላ ሰላም

(Pronunciation: ገላላ = deyebe = climbed, ሰላም = ashokhat = thorns, ለገላላ ሰላም = ayeqwarets'en = did not stop)

Page 12

[PICTURE: The shepherd cupping his ear, hearing a faint "Baa" sound in the distance, eyes lighting up with hope, starry night sky. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Then he heard a tiny sound. "Baa... baa..." It was faint and far away. The shepherd's heart leaped with joy! "I hear you! I'm coming!" he called.

TIGRINYA:

፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ "፡... ፡..." ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡ ፡፡፡፡ ፡፡፡! "፡፡፡፡፡፡'፡፡!
፡፡፡፡'፡፡!" ፡፡፡፡

(Pronunciation: ፡፡፡ = *dimts'i* = sound, ፡፡ = *libi* = heart, ፡፡፡ = *Hagos* = joy)

Page 13

[PICTURE: The shepherd finding his lost sheep stuck in thorny bushes on a ledge, reaching out his hands toward her. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

The shepherd found his little sheep! She was stuck in thorny bushes, trembling with fear. "Don't worry, little one," he said gently. "I found you! You are safe now."

TIGRINYA:

ገላ ገላ ለገላ ለገላ ለገላ! ገላ ለገላ ለገላ ለገላ ለገላ ለገላ "ገላ ለገላ
ገላ ለገላ ገላ ለገላ! ገላ ለገላ ገላ ለገላ"

(Pronunciation: ገላ = rekheba = found her, ለገላ = teshekila = stuck, ለገላ = wiHusti = safe)

[PICTURE: The shepherd gently removing thorns from the sheep's wool, carefully freeing her from the bushes with tender hands. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The shepherd carefully pulled the thorns from her soft wool. He freed her gently from the bushes. He checked to make sure she was not hurt anywhere.

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[PICTURE: The happy shepherd lifting the little sheep up onto his shoulders, both looking joyful, stars twinkling above. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then the shepherd lifted the little sheep up onto his strong shoulders. He held her close and safe. "I will carry you all the way home," he said with love.

[illegible]

(Pronunciation: **menkob** = shoulders, **al'ela** = lifted her, **kiskemeki** = carry you)

Page 16

[PICTURE: The shepherd walking home happily with the sheep on his shoulders, singing, a path lit by moonlight. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

The shepherd sang happy songs as he carried the sheep home. The little sheep felt warm and safe on his shoulders. She was not scared anymore!

TIGRINYA:

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ፊፊፊ ፊፊፊፊ ፊፊፊፊ ፊፊ ፊፊ ፊፊፊፊፊፊ!

(Pronunciation: ፊፊፊ = derfi = songs, ፊፊፊፊ = yizmir = singing, ፊፊፊ = miwuq = warm)

[PICTURE: The shepherd arriving home, the 99 sheep running toward him and the lost sheep, a warm pen with golden lamplight. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When the shepherd got home, the other ninety-nine sheep were so happy to see their friend! They gathered around, nuzzling the lost sheep. The family was complete again!

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 00 000'0 00000 000 00000 00 000 00 0000 000!

file:///projects/sandbox/children-bible-stories/books/book09_lost_sheep.html

Page 18

[PICTURE: The shepherd calling his neighbors and friends to his house, waving them over excitedly, the found sheep by his side. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

The shepherd was so happy that he called all his friends and neighbors! "Come celebrate with me!" he said. "I found my lost sheep! She is home safe!"

TIGRINYA:

ገላ ገላ ልጆች ልጆች ልጆች ልጆች ልጆች ልጆች! "ገላ ልጆች!" ገላ "ገላ ልጆች ልጆች ልጆች! ልጆች ገላ ገላ ልጆች!"

(Pronunciation: ልጆች = a'irukh = friends, ልጆች = gorebabi = neighbors, ልጆች = nits'emblu = celebrate)

[PICTURE: A joyful celebration with the shepherd's friends and neighbors gathered together, clapping, dancing, and laughing. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Everyone celebrated together! They clapped their hands and sang songs of joy. The shepherd danced and laughed. Finding his lost sheep made him the happiest man alive!

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file:///projects/sandbox/children-bible-stories/books/book09_lost_sheep.html

Page 20

[PICTURE: Jesus speaking warmly to the crowd, gesturing toward heaven, people looking thoughtful and touched by the story. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Then Jesus explained the story. "God is like that good shepherd," He said. "And each one of you is like His precious sheep. He loves you that much!"

TIGRINYA:

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ገጥሰ ገጥሰ ገጥሰ ገጥሰ ገጥሰ ገጥሰ!"

(Pronunciation: ገጥሰ = geletse = explained, ገጥሰ = kibirti = precious, ገጥሰ ገጥሰ = yifet'wekum = loves you)

[PICTURE: Jesus with arms wide open, golden light around him, showing God's love reaching out to one single person. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

"When even one person is lost," Jesus said, "God goes searching for them. He will never stop looking until He finds them. Every single person matters to God!"

[illegible]

(Pronunciation: ʒit'ef'i = *is lost*, yidelyo = *searches for him*, agedasi = *important*)

Page 22

[PICTURE: Angels in heaven celebrating joyfully, with musical instruments and bright light, looking down at Earth happily. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

"And when someone comes back to God," Jesus said, "all of heaven celebrates! The angels sing and dance with joy - just like the shepherd and his friends!"

TIGRINYA:

"፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፻" ፳፻፻ ፳፻ "፳፻ ፳፻፻ ፳፻፻፻! ፳፻፻፻ ፳፻፻፻ ፳፻፻፻፻፻ ፳፻፻፻፻፻ - ፳፻'፻ ፳፻፻ ፳፻፻፻፻፻!"

(Pronunciation: ፳፻፻ = semay = heaven, ፳፻፻፻፻ = mela'ikhti = angels, ፳፻፻፻፻፻ = yis'is'u = dance)

Page 23

[PICTURE: A child who was feeling alone looking up and seeing God's love represented as warm golden light surrounding them comfortingly. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

If you ever feel lost or alone, remember this story! God is always looking for you. He will never give up on you. You are never too far away for God to find you.

TIGRINYA:

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ገገገገገገገገገገገገገገገ ገገገገ ገገገገገገገገገገገ ገገገ ገገገገገገገገ ገገ ገገገገገገ

(Pronunciation: ገገገገገ = t'efi'ikum = feeling lost, ገገገ = zekru = remember, ገገገገገገገገገገገገገገ = ayHadgekumn = won't give up on you)

Page 24

[PICTURE: God's hands gently holding a small lamb, with the whole world visible below, showing how precious each person is. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

You are so special to God! Out of all the people in the world, He knows your name. He counts every hair on your head. You are His precious child!

TIGRINYA:

ፍላይተ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ! ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ
ፍላይተ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ ምሳኢ!

(Pronunciation: ፍላይተ = fluyat = special, ምሳኢ = simkum = your name, ምሳኢ = kibur = precious)

Page 25

[PICTURE: Happy children holding hands in a circle with a gentle shepherd figure watching over them, green meadow, sunshine, and lambs playing. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

ENGLISH:

Remember: God loves you like the shepherd loves his sheep! He will always come looking for you. You are never alone. Heaven celebrates because of YOU!

TIGRINYA:

፳፻፲፱፻፲፱: ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻'፲ ፳፻ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱፻፲፱! ፳፻ ፳፻ ፳፻፲፱፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱
፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱፻፲፱ ፳፻ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱ ፳፻፲፱!

(Pronunciation: ፳፻፲፱፻፲፱ = yifet'wekum = loves you, ፳፻፲፱፻፲፱ = kidelyekum = to search for you, ፳፻፲፱ = semay = heaven)

English: Every single person is precious to God! Just like the shepherd searched for his one lost sheep, God never gives up on anyone. His love reaches everywhere, and heaven celebrates when someone comes back to Him.

28/32

Bible Verse / ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ

English: "There will be more rejoicing in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent." - Luke 15:7

Tigrinya: "ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት" -
ቅዱስ 15:7

Talk About It / ስላሰብን'ኛ ስላሰብን

1. How many sheep did the shepherd have? / ስንት ስንት ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?
2. What did the shepherd do when one sheep was lost? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?
3. How did the shepherd feel when he found the lost sheep? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?
4. How does God feel about you? / ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን ስላሰብን?

English: Dear God, thank You for loving me so much that You would search for me anywhere. Help me to stay close to You always. Thank You that I am never alone. Amen.

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories Series

ብድህረ ገጽ ብድህረ ገጽ ብድህረ ገጽ ብድህረ ገጽ

1. ቤት ሙሴ ከቤት - Baby Moses in the Basket
2. ደብረ ደብረ - David and Goliath
3. ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - The Good Samaritan
4. ገጽ ገጽ - ገጽ ገጽ - Noah's Ark
5. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - Daniel in the Lions' Den
6. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ - Joseph's Colorful Coat
7. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ - Jonah and the Big Fish
8. ገጽ 5,000 ገጽ ገጽ - Jesus Feeds 5,000 People
9. ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - **The Lost Sheep** ገጽ
10. ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - Jesus Calms the Storm
11. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ - Queen Esther's Courage
12. ገጽ ገጽ - Ruth and Naomi
13. ገጽ ገጽ - ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - Creation
14. ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - The Prodigal Son
15. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ ገጽ - Elijah and Fire from Heaven
16. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ - Zacchaeus the Tax Collector
17. ደብረ ገጽ ገጽ - Abraham and Isaac
18. ገጽ ገጽ - The Tower of Babel
19. ገጽ ገጽ-ገጽ ደብረ ገጽ - Jesus Heals Blind Bartimaeus
20. ገጽ ገጽ ደብረ ገጽ - Jesus Heals Ten Lepers